FREE CHECKLIST

The AI Tool Starter Checklist

Three free tools cover writing, design, and selling for a one-person business. Set these up, use them for two weeks, and only then decide whether anything is worth paying for.

1 An AI assistant: ChatGPT or Claude FREE PLAN

Use it for: first drafts of emails, product descriptions, captions and content ideas. Pick one, not both.

- [ ] **Ask it for 3 versions of a one-sentence description of what you sell and who it's for.**
- [ ] **Save the prompt that worked. Reusing good prompts is where the time savings come from.**

2 Canva FREE PLAN

Use it for: social graphics, simple PDFs like this one, and anything visual you'd otherwise pay a designer for.

- [ ] **Pick 2 colors and 1 font, and build one template you'll reuse for every post.**

3 Systeme.io FREE PLAN

Use it for: landing pages, your email list and a checkout in one account. The free plan includes 2,000 contacts, 3 sales funnels and unlimited emails, with no credit card. **Know the limits:** 1 email campaign and 1 automation rule.

- [ ] **Build one opt-in page that offers something useful in exchange for an email address.**
- [ ] **Write a 3-email welcome sequence with your AI assistant from step 1.**

Start free: systeme.io/?sa=YOUR-ID

BEFORE YOU PAY FOR ANY AI TOOL, ASK

1. Does a free tool I already have do 80% of this?
2. Will I use it every week, or just this once?
3. Can I cancel monthly if it doesn't earn its keep?

The Systeme.io link is an affiliate link: if you later upgrade to a paid plan, I earn a commission at no extra cost to you. Systeme.io details checked against its pricing page, Nov 2026. Free plans change, so confirm on each tool's own pricing page.

Solo Stack